Trailmap Competitor Scan

Topic: How other outdoor/fitness apps handle first-run onboarding
Prepared by: Design (desk research, no vendor data used)

General pattern observed across the category

Most apps in this space ask 2-4 quick questions up front (experience level, typical distance or duration, preferred terrain) before showing any content, then use those answers to pick the first few items shown rather than a generic default list.

A smaller number skip the questions entirely and rely on a generic ’browse everything’ list on first open, leaning on search and filters instead of personalization.

Apps that ask questions up front tend to frame them as quick taps (single choice, large touch targets) rather than free text, keeping onboarding under 30 seconds in the flows we tried.

Implication for Trailmap

Our current onboarding shows the same unfiltered route list to every new user regardless of fitness level, which the usability notes tie directly to early drop-off. A short skill-level question before the first list render is a well-established pattern in this category, not a novel bet.

Open question for design: whether to ask preferred terrain as a second question, or hold that for a later moment once a user has saved at least one route.